



PHOTOS BY GETTY IMAGES

ing streamed—this year.

Elara Capital says this year's digital and TV un-bundling of advertisements is a disruption, and a monetisation opportunity for brands from the tournament. "The brand vertical split has changed this year, with fintech, retail tech, e-commerce, edtech, etc., being there [in the ad market] in very small portions because these companies have seen their ad spends cut down in the range of 20-40 per cent," says Karan Taurani, Senior VP-Research Analyst at Elara Capital.

An important trend is narrowcasting (targeted ads) instead of broadcasting, brand expert Manish Porwal explains. "Overall, digital and TV audiences have separated. Because of digital, which allows for brands to pick and choose its audience, it has allowed different kinds of brands to get in. The ability of a client to place his ad in his required slot has gone up and hence narrowcasting has gone up," says Porwal, MD of Alchemist India.

Taurani, too, says that digital is way more acceptable of local advertisers and niche advertising verticals, which are not that relevant for TV. "Traditional verticals are more skewed towards TV. They will have 70 per cent of their ads coming on TV," he says. **BT**

@PLidhoo

and ready-to-eat foods—has chosen India as its 10th market to rapidly scale operations in the next few years.

With Reliance Brands Ltd (RBL)—a subsidiary of Reliance Retail Ventures—as its master franchise partner, Pret's foray has come at a time when leading coffee chain operators in India are turning bullish about the country in anticipation of steady growth. Per industry estimates, the Indian coffeehouse market, currently pegged at \$3.2 billion, is growing at a CAGR of 9 per cent and it is expected to touch \$4.2 billion (₹34,000 crore) by 2025.

Calling it the "most ambitious global franchise partnership", Pret's CEO Pano Christou had said in a media release, the company is betting on RBL's expertise in the India market for the brand's success. "We have been working with RBL to create an offer for Indian consumers that reflects

\$4.20 billion

**EXPECTED SIZE OF THE
INDIAN COFFEEHOUSE
MARKET BY 2025, PER
INDUSTRY ESTIMATES**

the Pret brand, while also adapting to local preferences and food habits." While emails sent to them remained unanswered, sources say they plan to open nearly 100 stores in the next five years.

But market watchers say that there are multiple hurdles to overcome for Pret. Per Harish Bijoor, Founder of Harish Bijoor Consults, the chain would require a strong brand building exercise to establish itself among Indian consumers. "Starbucks has a stature among Indian consumers that no other

coffee brand enjoys. Moreover, Indians are inclined towards tea way more than they are towards coffee," he says.

As for Starbucks, it opened a whopping 71 outlets and entered 15 new cities in FY23, taking its stores' tally to 333. According to Sunil D'Souza, MD & CEO of Tata Consumer Products that manages the brand in India, the group "is looking to rapidly expand its presence in the coming years".

Deven Choksey, Founder & Promoter of KRChoksey Holdings says Reliance's nearly 18,000 outlets across formats could prove to be crucial for Pret. "Reliance would attempt to leverage its store presence... and sell Pret branded products through its existing counters. It would pitch Pret as a more affordable option; a strategy Reliance has followed for most of its business segments," he says. **BT**

@arndutt